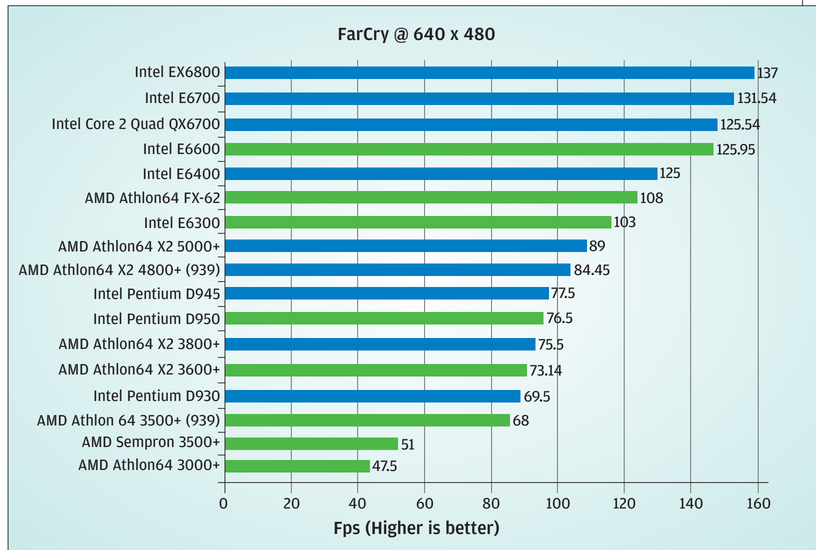
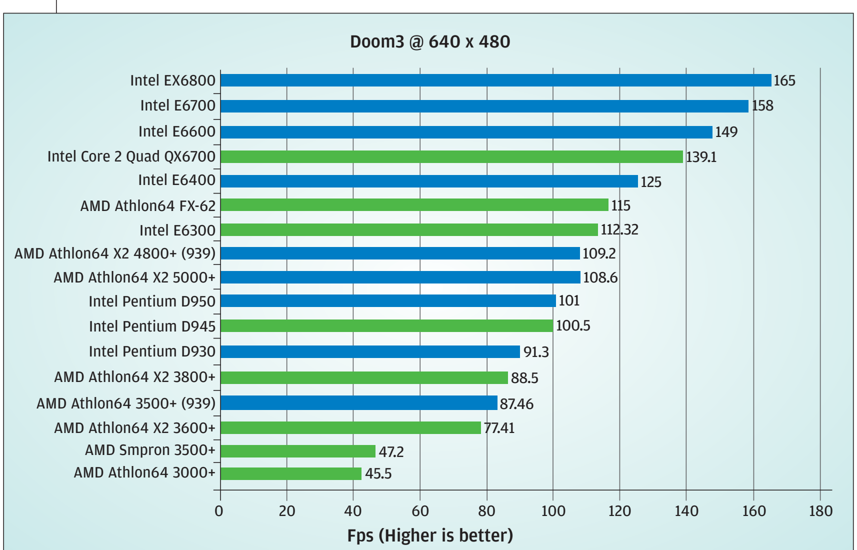
Far Cry

Intel's new Core 2 Duo processors beat the AMD and the older Pentium D processors by obscene margins. This is exactly the reverse of what happened when AMD launched their FX range of processors a year ago. The Intel EX6800 gives a 33 per cent better performance than the AMD FX-62 processor—a huge difference when it comes to gaming. However, the QX6700 (Quad Core) is marginally behind the EX6800, but that's expected—we will see better performance numbers only when games are optimised to take advantage of the extra cores.





Doom 3

The story repeats here—the Core 2 EX6800 posts the best scores, followed by the E6700 and the E6600. The QX6700 expectedly lags behind. The AMD FX-62 gets beaten by even the lowly E6400—and it's priced at a third of the FX-62's tag. Moreover, the E6300—the lowest in the Core 2 Duo—performs better than the Athlon64 X2 5000+ AM2 processor.

DivX Encoding

While DivX encoding has been the traditional playground for Intel processors largely due to the optimisation done in their favour, it's worthwhile to see how much of a difference it makes in real life applications. Here too, the Core 2 EX6800 tops the charts by completing the encoding in just 70 seconds. It's followed closely by the E6700 and the QX6700. AMD's FX-62 takes another 20 seconds more to complete the task. The lower-end E6600 and E6400 still offer better performance than the respective AMD processors. Strangely enough, the AMD X2 3600+ took less time than the AMD X2 3800+.